

Tommaso Isidori

None

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1. Tommaso Isidori

Experimental Physicist & Data Acquisition Engineer.

- [Download CV](#)
- [Publications](#)

2. About Me

Ciao! I am Tommaso Isidori, born and raised in Siena (Italy), and later emigrated to follow my passions, as many of my generation did. This is even more common for the ones who followed my same career path and decided to pursue their love for Physics.

Convinced by my lab experiences during high school and thanks to the remarkable enthusiasm of my teachers I decided to start walking this rocky road during my Bachelor degree, which I pursued in my hometown, Siena. During my last year, an unexpected internship brought me to CERN for the first time in my life, introducing me to the High Energy Physics field, as well as a lot of colleagues and mentors that supported my momentum and guided me in my first steps in the world of physics.

2.1 My life as a Physicist

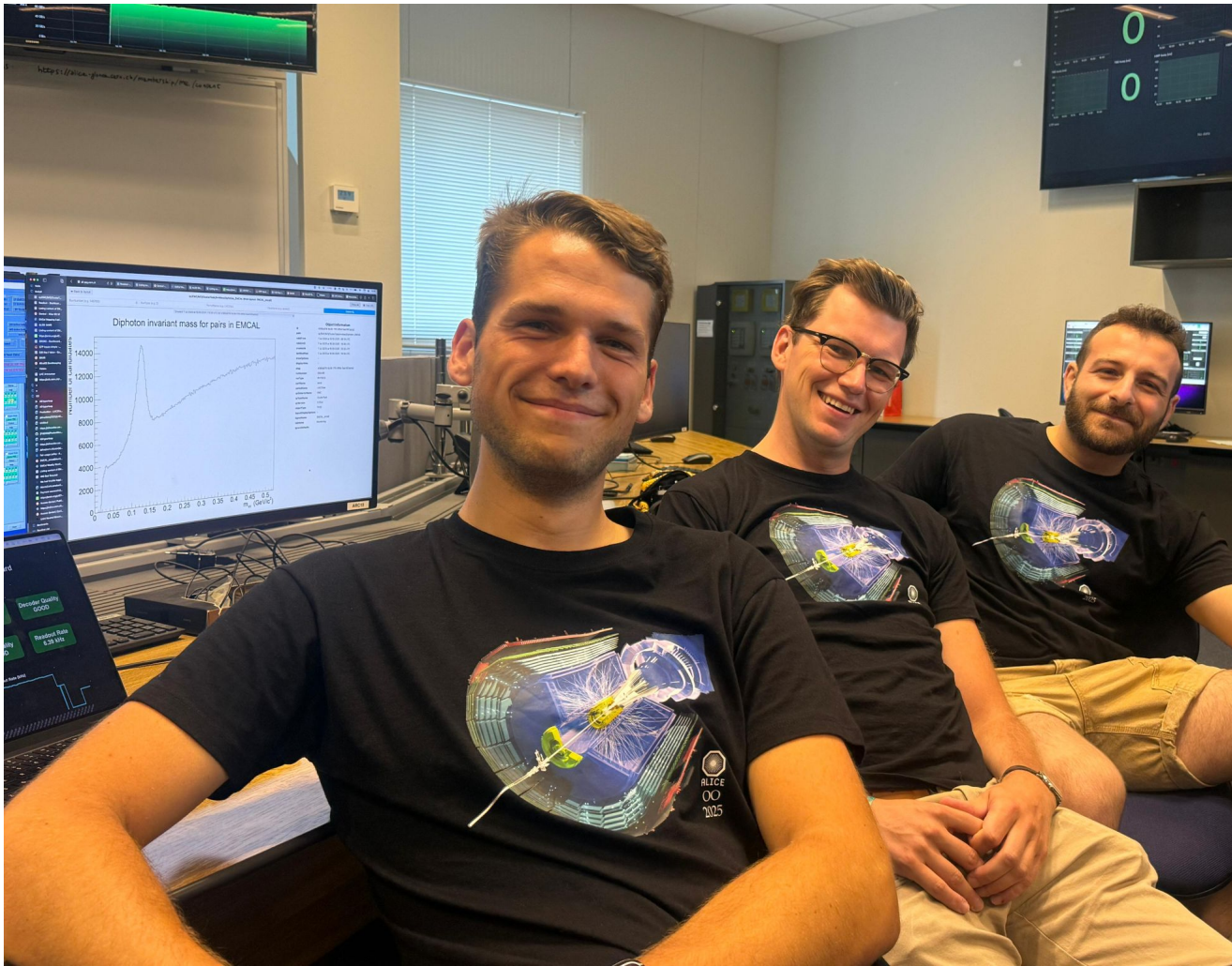
I am an experimental nuclear physicist with a passion and experience in particle detectors. I am currently serving as a postdoctoral researcher at the University of Kansas, but I am based at CERN in Geneva (CH) to coordinate the test activities of my experiment.



Group photos from Test campaigns (2022 - 2025)

I am deeply involved in the **ALICE FoCal experiment**, a forward calorimeter designed for the upgrade of the ALICE detector at the Large Hadron Collider (LHC). In this role, I serve as the **Test Beam Coordinator** and I am responsible for overseeing the FoCal laboratory. Since 2022 I directed the test, preparation, and optimization of the prototypes developed by our collaboration. ALICE FoCal is one of the two upgrade project of the ALICE experiment, at the LHC and more info can be found [Here](#).

Recently, I led the operation of the **EMCal detector of ALICE**, holding the position of **Technical Coordinator and System Run Coordinator** during the LHC 2025 proton-proton campaign, as well as the scheduled special runs (Oxygen-proton, Oxygen-Oxygen, Neon-Neon). Although demanding under so many aspects, this parenthesis of my physics career represented an invaluable learning experience, and provided me with a profound understanding of the operation of a running detector, and the privilege of working side by side with some of the best colleagues I met along my route.



N.Strangmann (left), F.Jonas (center), and I during the 2025 light ion data acquisition period

As part of my spin-off projects, I also contribute to detector **Research and Development (R&D)** efforts for calorimetry and fast timing for the future Electron-Ion Collider (EIC). My involvement in such a detector is a natural continuation of my studies on radiation-hard solid-state timing detectors for HEP and beam diagnostic pursued during my Master and PhD research.

Previously, I completed my **Ph.D. at the University of Kansas** under the supervision of Professor Christophe Royon. My doctoral studies were centered on particle physics, with a focus on the design, testing, and characterization of particle detectors for High Energy Physics experiments. My expertise spans various detector types, including timing, solid-state, and gas detectors. During my Ph.D., I contributed to two particle physics collaborations: the **Compact Muon Solenoid (CMS)** and the **TOTEM/PPS** collaborations. My thesis topics also included additional detector R&D projects, such as the design of a **NASA cubesat detector** for particle identification and the employment of **fast Si detectors** for single particle identification in high-rate medical facilities.

2.2 What else?

3. Tommaso Isidori

Experimental Physicist & Data Acquisition Engineer.

- [Download short CV](#)
- [Download extended CV](#)

4. CV Preview

TOMMASO ISIDORI

Experimental Physicist & Data Acquisition Engineer

✉ tommaso.isidori@cern.ch

☎ +33766749890

📍 Meyrin, Geneva (CH)

🌐 tommaso-isidori

🆔 000-0002-7934-4038

EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Researcher

CERN, ALICE Experiment

📅 2021 – Present

📍 CERN, Geneva (CH)

- Coordinate test campaigns, managing hardware, data collection, and analysis across international teams.
- Develop and maintain DAQ, readout, and control systems (C++, Python, Bash) and embedded monitoring tools.
- Support system operations, overseeing software, DAQ configuration, and on-call team training.
- Lead R&D on fast timing detectors, developing DAQ and signal analysis frameworks and mentoring students.

Ph.D. Researcher

University of Kansas (KU)

📅 2017 – 2022

📍 Lawrence, KS, USA

- Designed and characterized silicon detectors and front-end electronics for space, medical, and HEP applications.
- Led test beams and lab setups for fast silicon detector characterization at CERN and NASA.
- Conducted high-intensity radiotherapy detector studies, achieving single-particle resolution for dosimetry.

Internship at INFN Pisa

Università degli studi di Pisa

📅 2016 – 2017

📍 CERN, Geneva (CH)

- Designed, tested, and integrated high-speed solid-state sensors and electronics under high-radiation conditions.
- Led validation campaigns, developing DAQ software and performing system installation, calibration, and optimization.

Summer student at the TOTEM experiment

Università degli studi di Siena

📅 2013

📍 CERN, Geneva (CH)

- Developed and tested gas-based detectors, performing lab measurements and system characterization.
- Designed feedback systems for low-current monitoring, collaborating with electronics engineers on signal reliability.

ROLES AND AWARDS



Prototype performance coordinator of the ALICE FoCal project
2021 – current



Technical Coordinator and System Run Coordinator of the ALICE EMCal experiment
2024 – 2025



Responsible of laboratories at CERN
2021 – current



Awardee of the KU Graduate Fellowship Based on Exceptional Qualifications
2017 – 2018

STRENGTHS

Hard-working

Team work

Embedded Systems

Sensors & Detectors

Statistical Analysis

Coordination & Management

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Physics

The University of Kansas (KU)

📅 2017 - 2022

📍 Lawrence, KS, USA

Thesis title: *New Generation Fast Silicon Detectors for Timing and Particle Identification: High Energy Physics and Applications*

M.Sc. in Physics, Fundamental Interaction

Università degli studi di Pisa

📅 2014 - 2017

📍 Pisa, Italy

Thesis Title: *Diamond Detectors for Proton Time of Flight in CT-PPS and TOTEM Experiments*

B.Sc. in Physics

Università degli studi di Siena

📅 2010 - 2014

📍 Siena, Italy

Thesis Title: *Characterization and Optimization of Gas Detectors*